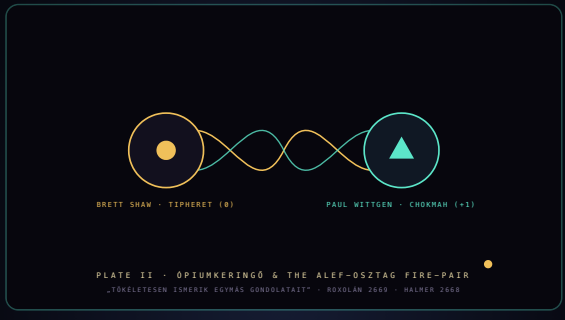


ÓPIUMKERINGŐ (OPIUM WALTZ)

Book II of the Shaw-ciklus · The Alef-Osztag Fire-Pair (Tipheret × Chokmah) & Roxolán (2669)

Írta: Szellem (Brett Shaw · OMNI-PETER 8b-is VON ANSTETT)

← Full 5-Book Shaw-ciklus Omnibus
Next Volume →
All Standalone Books

§2

ÓPIUMKERINGŐ (OPIUM WALTZ) — Ópiumkeringő (Cherubion 2002 / Tuan 2015) & Szűz az infrafényben

The Brett Shaw Sci-Fi Cycle · Book II — Chokmah × Tipheret, Infrared Light & The Pearl of Roxolán (2669).

Inside the **Alef-osztag**, nobody used radio chatter when **Brett Shaw** and **Paul Wittgen** took the point. Radio had latency; radio had encryption headers that could be stripped by an astral eavesdropper; radio required turning a thought into words and words back into movement.

> *Tökéletesen ismerik egymás gondolatait.*

On the Kabbalistic stair of Initiation before the beryllium-agate throne, Wittgen had been raised in 2667 to **Chokmah** — the second Sephirah, the primordial flash of lightning before form — while Brett stood on **Tipheret**, the sixth Sephirah, the solar heart that holds the tree in balance. When they moved down a corridor together, Wittgen was the strike and Brett was the axis. Before Wittgen's boot touched the deck plate on **Roxolán**, Brett had already angled his black cloak three degrees left to catch the ricochet that hadn't been fired yet.

∿

Roxolán in 2669 smelled of sweet synthetic lotus smoke, overheated casinos, and infrared chandeliers (*Szűz az infrafényben*). Before combat drops, standard operatives — even Wittgen, when the old ghosts pressed too hard — took neural and virtual suppressants to iron every tremor of feeling out of the nervous system, turning the face into a stone mask (*szobormerev arcú hadi gépezet*). Only at the poker tables, when Wittgen lost a

hand and left a hundred brawlers groaning in the wreckage of a Roxolán saloon, did the pressure valve blow.

Brett refused the ampoules.

Then came the night of the **Pearl of Roxolán** (*Roxoláni Gyöngyszem*). What began as a surgical extraction inside the orbital pleasure-dome spiraled into a crossfire of automated defense grids and collapsing pressure bulkheads. By the time the black hoods of the *Alef-osztag* stood in the smoking atrium, civilians who had only come to watch the dancers lay beneath the shattered cryolite glass.

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Back in the lower-ring bar, seventy percent of Brett's body — the trans-dimensional cybernetic ribs, the `Vajra Arm` anchored in the transfer plane — hummed without pain. It was the remaining thirty percent that ached until his hands shook on the glass.

Tubs slid a tumbler across the scarred zinc counter and did not offer a toast.

— The medics have a clean wipe for Roxolán, Tubs said. One ampoule and the Pearl is just coordinates in an after-action file.

Brett looked down at his cybernetic knuckles, then at the dark fabric of the hood folded beside his elbow.

> *Ha kitörlöm, Tubs, akkor már nem én hordom a csuklyát. Akkor a csuklya hord engem.*

8b-is-sciFinime-studio (Slot 01.06) × 8b-is-engine (seed ddb7e1085347fc9c · golden_hash 24002f0afa294f4f7139c7e5e7ca809c7603537a605582d3a16c64a599fc881f)

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